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കണ്ണൂർ ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്ത്

പൊതുവിദ്യാഭ്യാസ
വകുപ്പ്- കേരളം

ഡയറ്റ് കണ്ണൂർ

समग्र शिक्षा के रल
Samagra Shiksha Kerala
സമഗ്ര ശിക്ഷാ കേരളം



എസ് എസ് എൽ സി
വിദ്യാർത്ഥികൾക്കുള്ള
പഠനപിന്തുണാ സഹായി

ഇംഗ്ലീഷ്

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District Panchayath
Kannur

SMILE
ENGLISH

SSLC MODULE (PART 1)



Special Module for Improvement of Learning in Public Exams

2025-26

DIET
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PREFACE

As part of the curriculum revision, the SSLC English syllabus has been updated to reflect modern educational standards. The focus is on value-based, activity-oriented learning that enhances reading, writing, and comprehension skills, encouraging students to express themselves clearly and confidently.

This module supports diverse learning needs through thoughtfully designed units aligned with expected outcomes. Innovative teaching strategies promote active participation and meaningful engagement. Real-life contexts and relatable content aim to make learning more relevant and enjoyable, fostering critical thinking and creativity among students.

With careful attention to exam requirements, this resource serves both students and teachers—offering practical guidance for effective preparation and deeper understanding. It also promotes continuous learning through reflective exercises and integrated assessments, helping learners build a strong foundation in the usage of English language in various contexts.

ENGLISH (HS)

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UNIT 1

TRIALS AND TRIUMPHS

1. A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings: At a Glance

"A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings" by Gabriel Garcia Marquez is a powerful example of magical realism, which blends the ordinary and the extraordinary in a unique and captivating narrative style.

One gloomy afternoon, Pelayo saw a strange old man lying face down in the mud in his back courtyard. He had huge dirty wings. He looked weak and tired. Frightened, Pelayo and his wife Elisenda inspect the man closely. He was dressed in rags. His wings were stuck in the mud, and he could not get up. He appeared like a wet grandfather than a divine being.

The old man spoke an unknown language. They assumed that he might be a shipwrecked foreigner. But a neighbour woman said that he was an angel who had come for their sick child.

The next day, the entire town flocked to their courtyard to see the angel. They treated him like a strange animal. The visitors threw food at him. Pelayo locked him in the chicken coop to keep him safe. They charged five cents as an admission fee from the visitors to see the angel. Thus, they became rich, built a beautiful house, and lived in comfort. Pilgrims and others from far away places visited the angel, hoping for miracles. But the angel remained passive and patient, ignored and mistreated by people.

The people soon lost interest in the angel when a new attraction - a woman who had been turned into a spider - arrived in the town. They stopped visiting Pelayo's house, but by that time, the couple had made enough money. As time passed, the angel was forgotten. The chicken coop became dirty and broken, and the angel grew weaker. But, then slowly he survived. New feathers grew on his wings, and he started his attempts to fly again. One day, when Elisenda was cutting onions in the kitchen, she saw the angel struggling to fly. At last, he lifted off and disappeared into the distance. She watched him until he became a mere dot on the horizon. She felt a kind of relief as the burden had finally left their lives.

2. In The Attic : At a glance

"In the Attic" is an except from Wadyslaw Szpilman's survivor testimony titled "The Pianist."It revolves around the unusual friendship between Szpilman and Captain Wilm Hosenfeld, a German officer. Szpilman was hiding in an attic during the final days of war in Warsaw. The German officer

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finds him in an abandoned building and asks him to play the piano. He played Chopin's Nocturne in C- sharp minor, which moved the officer deeply. The officer offered to take Szpilman to a safer location, and it was then that he learned that Szpilman was a Jew. He told Szpilman not to stay in the city as it was dangerous. But Szpilman was not ready to leave. The officer helped him to find a better hiding place in a small loft above the attic. The officer brought him food and supplies, He admitted to the fact that he was ashamed of identifying himself as a German. He told Szpilman that the war would soon be over and that he must "hang on" to survive. Szpilman continued to live in isolation often without human contact for long intervals. The only sound heard was the artillery fire and the soldiers going up and down the stairs where he was hiding. Before leaving the city, the officer came one last time to Szpilman and gave him extra food and a warm blanket. He advised Szpilman not to lose heart. At the parting moment Szpilman expressed his gratitude and promised to repay the officer's kindness and assistance. Szpilman survived another year there. One morning, he heard Polish announcements that the war was over and Warsaw was free. He stayed in a confused state, not knowing what to do. Then he came across the voices of women and children down the street. Excited, but cautious, he put on the German coat the officer had given him and went outside. A woman who mistook him as a German officer screamed. At that, a Polish guard shot at him, and he ran back into the attic. Later, the soldiers understood the situation, and Szpilman was rescued. For the first time in six years, he walked freely through the streets of Warsaw. The friendship between Szpilman and the German officer remains a powerful testament to the human capacity for connection and compassion even in the most challenging circumstances. Szpilman's story is a testament to the human spirits' ability to persevere in the face of adversity.

3. Friends Romans Countrymen : At a glance

Friends, Romans Countrymen is a famous speech by Mark Antony in the play "Julius Caesar" of William Shakespeare . At the time of Caesar's funeral, Antony seeks Brutus' permission to render a funeral eulogy to Caesar.

Through the ironical words, Mark Antony reveals the secret of the assassination of Caesar by his bosom friend Brutus and the conspirators. He repeats some words and expressions to make the crowd aware of their motive. He also reminds the people about the good deeds of Caesar. So he persuades them to revenge Caesar's murder. The famous eulogy is embellished by wonderful literical devices like metaphor (ambition should be made of sterner stuff),alliteration (friend faithful, brutish beasts) irony (The noble Brutus, Brutus is an honourable man) hyperbole (my

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heart is in the coffin there with Caesar) etc. It's no wonder Mark Antony's masterpiece of oration is written in golden letters of the annals of history.

1. Textual Comprehension

1.1. Read the excerpt from A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings and answer the questions that follow.

The light was weak, even at noon. When Pelayo was coming back to the house, it was hard for him to see what was moving and groaning in the rear of the courtyard. He had to go very close to see that it was an old man, a very old man. The man was lying face down in the mud. In spite of his tremendous efforts, the man couldn’t get up, impeded by his enormous wings.

Frightened by the sight, Pelayo ran to get Elisenda, his wife. She was putting compresses on their sick child.

Part A: Multiple-Choice Questions

1. What was the condition of the light when Pelayo first saw the old man?
   a) Bright and sunny b) Weak, even at noon
   c) Dark and stormy d) Clear and warm

2. What was the old man lying on when Pelayo found him?
   a) A bed b) The ground
   c) Mud d) The chicken coop

3. Why couldn’t the old man get up?
   a) He was too tired. b) His wings were enormous and impeded him.
   c) He was injured in a fall. d) He was asleep.

4. What was Pelayo’s reaction when he saw the old man?
   a) He was excited. b) He was frightened.
   c) He was indifferent. d) He laughed.

5. Who did Pelayo run to after seeing the old man?
   a) His neighbor b) A doctor
   c) Elisenda, his wife d) His friend

Part B: Short Answer Questions

6. What was hard for Pelayo to see when he came back to the house?

7. What was preventing the old man from getting up?

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8. What was Elisenda doing when Pelayo called her?

9. How did Pelayo feel when he saw the old man?

10. Identify the Noun Phrase in the subject position and Verb Phrase from the sentence given below.

She was putting compresses on their sick child.

Part C :Match the word to its meaning.

Word	Meaning
Groaning	A. Very big
impede	B. Wet cloth for healing
Compresses	C. Making a sad sound
Enormous	D. Prevent

1.2. Read the excerpt from A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings and answer the questions that follow.

The man was dressed like a ragpicker. There were only a few faded hairs left on his bald skull and very few teeth in his mouth. His pitiful condition seemed that of a drenched great-grandfather. This took away any sense of grandeur he might have had. His huge buzzard wings, dirty and

half-plucked, were entangled in the mud.

They looked at him so long and so closely that Pelayo and Elisenda very soon overcame their surprise. In the end they found him familiar. Then they dared speak to him. He answered in an incomprehensible dialect with a strong sailor's voice.

1. How was the man dressed ?
2. Pick out the word from the passage which means unknown language .
3. The old man looked like a ----------

a) Drenched great grandfather b) Contented man

c) Sailor d) Angel

4. How did Pelayo and Elisenda react to the arrival of the old man?
5. How is the man's wings portrayed ?

a) Entangled in the mud b) Large and stiff

c) Dirty and half plucked d) Tiny

Choose the correct option from the following:

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i. Both A and B ii. Both B and C

iii. Both A and C iv. Both A and D

1.3. Read the excerpt from "In the Attic" and answer the questions that follow.

On 14 January unusual noises in the building and the street outside woke me. Soldiers ran up and down the stairs, and I heard agitated, nervous voices. Early in the morning of 15 January, the sound of artillery from the previously silent front was heard. The ground and the walls of the building shook under the constant dull thunder. Three hours later the heavy artillery fire died down again, but I was as nervous as ever. I did not sleep at all that night. The street fighting would begin at any moment, and I could be killed.

The night passed peacefully. Around one o'clock I heard the remaining Germans leaving the building. Silence fell. I could not even hear the steps of the guards outside the building. Not until the early hours of the next day was the silence broken by a loud and resonant noise, the last sound I had expected. Radio loudspeakers set up somewhere nearby were broadcasting announcements in Polish of the defeat of Germany and the liberation of Warsaw.

1.What unusual events woke the narrator on 14th January?

2. How did the narrator describe the silence after the Germans left?

3. Why didn't the narrator sleep that night?

4.What message was broadcast over the radio loudspeakers?

a) the victory of Germany b) the defeat of Warsaw

c) the liberation of Warsaw d) the liberation of Germany

5. Identify the Noun Phrase in the subject position and Verb Phrase from the sentence given below.

Radio loudspeakers set up somewhere nearby were broadcasting announcements in Polish

2. Poem Analysis

2.1. Read the lines from the dramatic speech 'Friends, Romans, Countrymen...' and answer the questions that follow.

Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears;

I come to bury Caesar, not to praise him.

The evil that men do lives after them;

The good is oft interred with their bones;

So let it be with Caesar. The noble Brutus

Hath told you Caesar was ambitious:

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If it were so, it was a grievous fault;

And grievously hath Caesar answered it.

Part A : Multiple Choice Questions

1. Who is the speaker addressing in the speech?
   a) Senators only
   b) Friends, Romans, and countrymen
   c) The audience at a festival
   d) Brutus

2. What does Antony say he came to do?
   a) To praise Caesar
   b) To bury Caesar
   c) To criticize Brutus
   d) To celebrate Caesar's achievements

3. According to the speaker, what “lives after” men?
   a) Only their good deeds
   b) Only their wealth
   c) The evil that men do
   d) Their families

4. How does the speaker describe Brutus?
   a) As a traitor
   b) As a noble man
   c) As Caesar’s enemy
   d) As an ambitious leader

Part B: Short Answer Questions

5. What does Antony say about Caesar's ambition?

6. What does the phrase “grievous fault” suggest about Caesar's ambition?

7. What does the speaker say happens to the good deeds of men?

8. What poetic device is in the phrase “The noble Brutus”?

2.2. Read the lines from the dramatic speech ‘Friends, Romans, Countrymen...’ and answer the questions that follow.

You all did see that on the Lupercal

I thrice presented him a kingly crown,

Which he did thrice refuse: was this ambition?

Yet Brutus says he was ambitious;

And, sure, he is an honourable man.

I speak not to disprove what Brutus spoke,

But here I am to speak what I do know.

You all did love him once, not without cause:

What cause withholds you, then, to mourn for him?

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O judgement, thou art fled to brutish beasts,

And men have lost their reason! - Bear with me;

My heart is in the coffin there with Caesar,

And I must pause till it come back to me.

1. Which festival is mentioned here?
2. Pick out the lines that show Caesar was not ambitious
3. Identify the poetic device used in the line

   "My heart is in the coffin there with Caesar"

   a) alliteration b) simile

   c) hyperbole d) anaphora

4. "Thou art fled to brutish beasts"- what does the expression here mean ?

3. Possible Discourses

3.1. Review

Blending magic with reality, Marquez's A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings stands as a remarkable tale that invites deep reflection. Write a critical review of the story, focusing on its central theme, the characterization , the ambience created and the author's distinctive style of narration.

3.2. Character sketch

a. In the story "A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings", the writer skillfully presents the character of Pelayo through his involvement in and reactions to various events. Prepare a **character sketch** of Pelayo, bringing out his main traits as revealed in the story.

Pelayo, one of the central figures in the story"A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings". Marquez portrayed him as a representative of the common man who encounters a supernatural event in the midst of his ordinary life. As a bailiff, he holds responsibility to the public, yet his foremost concern is the safety of his family. His reaction to the strange old man with wings reflects both fear and duty: startled by the unexpected sight of the winged creature trapped in the mud, his immediate instinct is to run to his wife, Elisenda, for support.

Together, they approach the old man, whom they initially mistake for a shipwrecked castaway. However, when their neighbour lady interprets him as an angel who might have come for their

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sick child, Pelayo's fear deepens. That evening , he sits in his kitchen armed with his bailiff's club, and before going to bed, he drags the old man into the chicken coop—an act that demonstrates both his anxiety and his desire to shield his loved ones.

Pelayo's humanity is evident in his conflicting impulses. When his child is mysteriously cured, he contemplates sending the winged man back to sea with provisions. Yet, when the crowd gathers, he agrees with Elisenda's suggestion to charge an entry fee. Although this decision reveals his willingness to profit from the situation, it also reflects his practicality as a common man struggling for survival. He uses the money wisely—resigning from his job, starting a new business, and building a comfortable new house for his family.

Despite exploiting the old man for financial gain, Pelayo does not abandon his empathy and soft feelings. He allows the winged stranger to remain in his courtyard, worries about his health, and provides him with a blanket during the winter. These gestures, though modest, show his underlying kindness.

Thus, Pelayo emerges as a complex character—fearful yet protective, practical yet humane. He embodies the struggles of an ordinary man torn between survival, morality, and the mystery of the unknown.

b. In the story 'A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings,' the writer vividly portrays the Old Man through his mysterious appearance and the different responses he provokes in the people around him. Prepare a **character sketch** of the Old Man.

c. In the story "A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings," Marquez effectively reveals Elisenda's character through her actions and attitudes toward the Old Man and the unfolding events. Prepare a **character sketch** of Elisenda.

d. "In the Attic" the German officer, is depicted as a compassionate and morally conflicted man amid the brutal realities of World War II. Although a soldier in the Nazi army, he shows kindness and empathy toward Szpilman. Prepare a **character sketch** of the German officer.

3.3. Letter

a. In the story "A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings," imagine Pelayo writes a letter to his friend describing a strange and unforgettable incident that occurred in his courtyard. In the letter, he shares

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his personal observations, the reactions of the villagers, and the lessons he learned from the experience. Write the letter.

Key features

1. *Relevant to the context → Mentions the old man's arrival, villagers' reaction, his suffering, and departure.*
2. *Language suitable for informal/personal letter → Friendly tone, use of "My dear friend," and "Do write back soon."*
3. *Proper salutation and farewell phrase → "My dear friend" (salutation), "Yours lovingly" (farewell).*
4. *Message conveyed → Lesson: miracles appear in ordinary forms, need for compassion.*
5. *Well-formed sentences → Clear, grammatically correct, complete sentences.*
6. *Ideas linked properly → Arrival → villagers' reaction → old man's endurance → his departure → moral/lesson.*

KK House
Seashore village
27 September 2025

My dear friend,

I am writing to tell you about a strange and unforgettable incident that happened in our village. One stormy night, an old man with enormous wings appeared in our courtyard. At first, we were shocked and frightened. His wings were muddy and broken, and he looked more like a beggar than an angel.

Soon the whole village gathered to see him. People brought food, money, and even advice, but they treated him more like a creature in a circus than a human being. Though everyone called him an angel, very few showed him kindness. He remained silent and patient, bearing all the ridicule and stares.

After many days, when his strength slowly returned, the old man began to spread his wings. It was an amazing sight. At last, he rose into the sky and disappeared beyond the horizon. Watching him fly away filled me with wonder and guilt. We realised too late that we had failed to respect a miracle when it was with us.

This incident has taught me that extraordinary things can appear in the most ordinary forms, and that true humanity lies in compassion, not curiosity.

Do write back soon. Convey my regards to your family.

Yours lovingly,
Pelayo

b. In the story "In the Attic," Wladyslaw Szpilman was finally saved by the Polish Army after enduring many hardships during the war. He writes a letter to his friend describing his experiences of survival, hiding, and his feelings when he was rescued by the Polish Army. write the likely **letter**.

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3.4. Advertisement jingles

In the story “A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings”, the visit of the spider-woman attracted large crowds as she shared her experiences and answered the queries that the people raised. Imagine you are the manager of the advertisement wing. Write catchy advertisement jingles to attract people to the exhibition.

3.5. News Report

a. In the story A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings, the old man finally flew away into the sky while Elisenda watched him from the kitchen. Imagine this incident being reported as the next day’s breaking news. Prepare a **news report** on the event, highlighting the recent developments and the transformation in the old man’s physical condition.

b. The defeat of Germany and the liberation of Warsaw was a leading news event covered by newspapers worldwide. Imagine you are a reporter assigned to write a news report on this historic event. Prepare a **news report.**

3.6. Diary

a. Elisenda was much relieved when the old man with enormous wings left their house and flew away. Draft the possible diary entry by Elisenda on that day.

b. In the story "In the Attic," Wladyslaw Szpilman meets a German officer who shows him kindness and compassion. Szpilman writes a **diary** describing his thoughts and feelings on the day of their first meeting. Include his emotions, his reaction to the officer's kindness, and how this meeting affected his hope for survival. Write the likely diary entry

3.7. Conversation

a. In the story "In the Attic," the Polish army spots Szpilman hiding in the attic, and a lieutenant questions him. Write a **conversation** between Szpilman and the lieutenant that shows Szpilman's fear, the lieutenant's attitude, and their conversation about Szpilman's situation.

b**.** Prepare a possible **conversation** between Elisenda and Pelayo after the old man with enormous wings left their house and flew away.

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3.8. Speech

The after-effect of war is widespread devastation, including loss of life, psychological trauma, economic collapse, and long-term social and political instability. On the basis of your reading of 'In the Attic', prepare a speech to be delivered in the school assembly on 'War and Its Consequences'.

3.9. Interview Questions

Imagine you are the correspondent of a daily who gets a chance to interview Szpilman after the liberation of Warsaw. Prepare a set of five questions to be asked in the interview.

4. Phrasal Verbs

4.1. Here is a WhatsApp chat of a villager who visited the old man. Complete the chat using the appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets."

Ravi [10:30AM]:

I just ----- a -------- an old man with wings at Pelayo's place.

Meera [10:31 AM]:

What?! An angel??

Ravi [10:32 AM]:

Maybe! They've been ------ b ------ him for days.

And guess what? He just ------ c ------ into the sky.

(put up with, take off, look after,came across)

4.2. Imagine the German officer in the story "In the Attic" accidentally found Szpilman hiding in the attic while on patrol. He writes an email to his wife describing his encounter with Szpilman and how his music moved him . Complete the e mail using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

Subject: An Encounter That Changed My Heart

My Dear,

While on patrol through the ruins of Warsaw, I------a----- a man hiding in an attic of an abandoned building. He was Władysław Szpilman, a frail pianist. When I asked him to play the piano, despite his weakness, he-----b------ with a stunningly poignant melody that lifted the weight of this war from my soul.

Deeply moved, I had to------c------ quickly to either leave him or help. I couldn't just-----d----- on him. I decided to--------- a safer hiding place for him and started secretly bringing him food and some warm clothes.

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Every time I-----e----- the courage to visit him, I feel hope that kindness can survive even in these dark times.

Yours,

Robert

(make up one's mind, turned up, come across, call up, give up, set up)

5. Conversation Completion

5.1. Imagine Pelayo walks back into the house after locking up the old man with enormous wings. He and Elisenda have a conversation about what just happened. Write the conversation between Pelayo and Elisenda.

Pelayo: I locked him in the shed.

Elisenda: That was a bit cruel, wasn't it?

Pelayo: Maybe, but we had no choice.

Elisenda: What if someone finds out he's there?

Pelayo: Then we'll be in trouble. If the priest sees him, he might tell everyone.

Elisenda: Did he try to speak to you?

Pelayo: No, he just made strange noises.

Elisenda: Where do you think he came from?

Pelayo: I have no idea. We had better not tell anyone for now.

A. Read the dialogue and underline the following .

- The question tag : *(Positive sentence = auxiliary +n' t + pronoun*

  Negative sentence= auxiliary + pronoun)

- The wh-question : *(QW.+Auxiliary+ subject+ verb eg: When will you go?)*
- The yes/no question : *(auxiliary +sub+ verb eg: Will you go tomorrow?)*
- The if-clause : *(Type I - If + present simple, will + base verb*

  Type II - If + past simple, would + base verb

Type III - If + past perfect, would have + past participle

The had better : *(Had better+ base form of the verb)*

B: Fill in the blanks

Complete each sentence using the correct grammar structure shown in brackets.

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1. You saw the wings, _____? *(question tag)*
2. _____ did he land in our yard? *(wh-question)*
3. _____ he understand what we say? *(yes/no question)*
4. If we leave him alone, he _____. *(if-clause)*
5. We _____ call someone to help. *(had better)*

C. Write a conversation among Pelayo, Elisenda, and their neighbour when they discovered an old man with wings in their courtyard.

Pelayo : Good morning, You won't believe what I found last night.
(Proper beginning + brief expression)
Neighbour Woman : What did you find, Pelayo? *(Wh-question)*
Pelayo : An old man with enormous wings lying in my courtyard. Can you imagine? *(Yes/No question)*
Neighbour Woman : Oh! How strange! Are you sure you saw it clearly? *(Interjection + Yes/No question)*
Elisenda : Yes, it's true. He looks tired and miserable, doesn't he? *(Question tag)*
Neighbour Woman : Goodness! Why don't you call the priest? He may know whether he is an angel or not. *(Interjection + Wh-question)*
Pelayo : That's a good idea. But should we keep him in the chicken coop?
(Yes/No question)
Elisenda : Hmm… I think it's safe. After all, people may come to see him, won't they?
(Question tag)
Neighbour Woman : Exactly! Poor fellow, though. He looks harmless.
Pelayo : Well then, let's take care of him until we know the truth, shall we?
(Question tag)
Elisenda : Yes, that's the best we can do for now. Thank you for your advice.
(Proper ending – polite closure)

D. Complete the conversation between Elisenda and Pelayo.

Pelayo : .....(a).....?
Elisenda : It flew away.
Pelayo : .....(b).....?
Elisenda : Yes, I saw him flying while I was in the kitchen.
Pelayo : Why didn't you call me then? If you had called me,.....(c).....
Elisenda : I never thought that the angel would fly.
Pelayo: People may find it strange. You had better.....(d).....
Elisenda : OK, I will inform our neighbours.
Pelayo : Anyway, You seemed relieved,.....(e).....?

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6. Question Construction

Types of Questions:

• *Literal: Based directly on facts from the text.*

• *Inferential: Based on clues or implied meaning.*

• *Analytical: Focused on deeper meaning, purpose, or effects.*

• *Word Meaning: Focused on vocabulary or specific words.*

7.1 Read the passage given below and *frame four appropriate questions* based on it.

The light was weak, even at noon. When Pelayo was coming back to the house, it was hard for him to see what was moving and groaning in the rear of the courtyard. He had to go very close to see that it was an old man, a very old man.

• **Literal:** Who was moving in the courtyard?

• **Inferential:** Why do you think the light was weak even at noon?

• **Analytical:** How does the weak light contribute to the mood of the passage?

• **Word Meaning:** What does the word ‘groaning’ mean in the passage?

7.2. Read the passage given below and *frame four appropriate questions* based on it.

On 12 December, the officer came for the last time. He brought me a larger supply of bread than before and a warm eiderdown. He told me he was leaving Warsaw with his detachment, and I must on no account lose heart.

8. Cloze Type

Fill in the blanks using appropriate words from the bracket.

But when they went out .....(a)..... the courtyard .....(b)..... the first light .....(c)..... dawn, they found .....(d).... whole neighbourhood in front of the chicken coop having fun .....(e).... the angel.

(of, the, with, into, at)

It so happened that during those days there arrived-----(a)---- the town a travelling show. The main attraction was a woman who had been changed---(b)----- a spider---(c)---- a burst of thunder and lightning. The admission fee to see her was less than---(d)--- fee to see the angel. So, the people flocked---e--- see her.

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(into ,the , to, in, by,)

When I placed my fingers .....(a)..... the keyboard they shook. I hadn't practised .....(b).... two and half years, my fingers were stiff .....(c).... covered with ....(d)....thick layer ....(e).... dirt, and I had not cut my nails for some weeks.

(for, on, a, of, and)

9. Reported Speech

Report the following conversations.

1. Neighbour : Where did you find the old man with enormous wings?
   Elisenda : He was lying face down in the mud.
2. Elisenda : Shall we charge five cents for admission to see the angel?
   Pelayo : It is a good idea.
3. Villager: why are so many people gathered outside your house?
   Pelayo : An old man with wings has appeared in my courtyard.
4. Officer : Shall I take you out of the city?
   Szpilman : I can't leave this place.
5. Szpilman : How will I survive the street fighting?
   Officer : It is obviously God's plan for us to live.

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UNIT 2

PATHS TO PROGRESS

1. BREAKING BARRIERS: I WILL FLY: At a glance

This autobiographical piece tells the story of Srikanth Bolla, who was born blind. His parents were farmers in a small village in Andhra Pradesh. They accepted their son as he was and brought him up with love and care. When his father saw that Srikanth was not of much help in the fields, he decided to send him to the nearby school. At school Srikanth had to face many problems. He was made to sit on the last bench and ignored by his teachers and friends. After two years, his father sent him to a special school in Hyderabad where there were children like him. Srikanth excelled in all activities. He passed his 10th grade with 90% marks. Despite facing discrimination and rejection from the society again when he was denied admission to science stream in school—he persevered. With an order from the government that he could study science at his own risk, he completed his 12th grade with 98% marks. With the support of his parents and mentor, he went on to study at MIT (Massachusetts Institute of Technology) and later established a successful enterprise, Bollant Industries. The purpose of this enterprise was to rehabilitate, nurture and reintegrate disabled individuals into society.

The lesson emphasizes the importance of determination, courage, and breaking societal barriers. Srikanth's journey is a testament to how one can rise above limitations and create opportunities not just for oneself, but for others too.

2. A Phoenix Rises : At a glance

This inspiring story is based on the real-life journey of Arunachalam Muruganantham, a humble man from rural Tamil Nadu who became a pioneer in menstrual hygiene.

The story follows Bablu, a fictional character who mirrors Muruganantham's life. After the death of his father, Bablu had to drop out of school at a very early age and look for a job to help his mother who was working hard to support the family. He got a job in a workshop as a busboy. He worked hard to become a welder and gradually took over the workshop and slowly improved the business. He got married and after his marriage he noticed things that he felt required urgent attention. One day he found his wife use unhygienic cloth during her periods, Bablu was deeply disturbed.

He learned that commercial sanitary pads were too expensive for poor families. Determined to help, he began experimenting with making low-cost sanitary pads.Despite being mocked, misunderstood, and abandoned by his own family, Bablu never gave up. He tested materials, built machines, and

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finally discovered a way to make affordable pads using pinewood pulp. His invention not only improved women's health but also created jobs for rural women.

Like a phoenix rising from the ashes, Bablu rose above rejection and humiliation to bring hope, dignity, and change to society. The story also highlights how one's determination can remove the taboos existing in society and bring in positive changes.

3. The Seedling

by Paul Laurence Dunbar

Summary

Paul Laurence Dunbar's poem "The Seedling" is a gentle and inspiring piece that uses the journey of a small plant to reflect the struggles and growth of human life. The seedling, though not strong, decides to do its best and begins its journey from the dark soil to the light of day. It symbolizes human potential and the journey of growth from darkness to light. The poem conveys the message of how we must rise above challenges with courage and hope.

The poem teaches us that even if we are not perfect or powerful, we can still grow, succeed, and bloom by putting in effort and staying positive. The seedling's determination, teamwork, and patience show us the values of hard work and self-belief.

The poem uses a several poetic devices like simile " Little folks, be like the seedling", metaphor " darksome bed", personification "To itself it fell a talking," and alliteration in " So it pushed a little leaflet". The seedling is given human qualities of thinking and working. The growth of the seedling is a metaphor for the human growth. The overall tone is cheerful and motivational, inspiring the readers to embrace life's challenges with a positive attitude and to always do their best. The poem has a steady rhythm with words like 'bed-said', and 'day-way'. The poem inspires us to grow through struggles and effort with love and kindness.

Reading Comprehension

1.1. Read the following excerpt from 'Breaking Barriers I will Fly' and answer the questions that follow.

Despite the challenges of trekking to a faraway school and being ignored by teachers and classmates, I persevered. For two years, I sat on the last bench, excluded from activities. I then felt like the poorest child in the world—not on account of lack of money, but because of loneliness and isolation.

Eventually, my parents and relatives decided that I should study in a school with students like me. So, I was sent to a special school in Hyderabad. There I excelled, becoming an outstanding student, earning top ranks, and representing India in chess and cricket. I had the privilege of working with Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam on various projects like the Lead India Youth Transformation Project.

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When I completed my 10th grade with over 90% marks I wanted to study science at the A.P. State Board. However, I was told I could only take arts because I was 'impaired.' I did not consider myself visually impaired but visually 'challenged.' I was not allowed to pursue my passion due to the perceptions of others. Rather than accept this, I decided to sue the government.

1. What was the attitude of the teachers and students towards young Srikanth?
2. Why did Srikanth feel like 'the poorest child in the world'?
3. Who decided to send Srikanth to the special school in Hyderabad
    a. Classmates
    b. Parents and relatives
    c. Brother
    d. Neighbour
4. Srikanth was told to take arts because
    a. He loved arts
    b. He was too poor to study science
    c. He was 'visually impaired'
    d. His friend suggested him to take arts.

    Choose the correct option.
    i. Only (a) is correct
    ii. Only (b) is correct
    iii. Only © is correct
    iv. None of the above
5. What made Srikanth sue the government?

Answers

1. Teachers and students ignored Srikanth Bolla.
2. Srikanth felt like the poorest child in the world because he sat on the last bench for more than two years and was excluded from activities in the school.
3. His parents and relatives.
4. (iii) only © is correct.
5. Srikanth sued the government as he was not allowed to study science.

1.2. Read the following excerpt from 'Breaking Barriers I will Fly' and answer the questions that follow.

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Should I just get married, settle down and work in corporate America? No, I wanted to solve the problems I had faced. Why should blind children be made to sit on the last bench? Why should 10% of India's population, who are disabled, be excluded from the economy?

These questions led me back to India, where I returned, giving up all the opportunities in corporate America, to build a strong support system for the disabled. We established a platform, Bollant Industries together with my partner, to find, rehabilitate, nurture, and reintegrate disabled individuals into society, rather than separate them from it.

1. What was the name of Srikanth's Entrepreneurship?
2. Why did the narrator return to India?
   a) To pursue a career in politics
   b) To build a support system for the disabled
   c) To start a business for profit.
   d) To work with Dr. Abdul Kalam → Answer: B
3. Assertion (A): The narrator returned to India from corporate America.
   Reason (R): The narrator wanted to build a support system for disabled individuals.
   Options:
   A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
   B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A.
   C) A is true, but R is false.
   D) A is false, but R is true.
4. Why did Srikanth start 'Bollant Industry'?
5. Find out the word that means 'to restore to good health'.

Answers:

1. Bollant Industries.
2. (b) to build a support system for the disabled.
3. A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A.
4. Srikanth started Bollant Industries to find, rehabilitate, nurture and reintegrate disabled individuals into society.
5. rehabilitate

1.3. Read the following excerpt from 'Breaking Barriers I will Fly' and answer the questions that follow.

After six months of legal battle, I received a government order allowing me to study science, but at my own risk. Despite the lack of resources, I worked hard, with the help of a mentor. She recorded

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my textbooks on audio, and I scored 98% in my exams. This proves that anyone, regardless of their 'impairment' or challenges, can achieve great things.

However, my journey didn't end there. When it was time to apply to top engineering schools like IIT, I was told that I couldn't sit for the competitive exams because of my blindness. If IIT didn't want me, I decided I didn't want it either. I applied to top schools in the United States and was accepted into MIT, Stanford, Berkeley, and Carnegie Mellon. I chose to attend MIT, becoming the first international blind student in its history

1.For how long did the legal battle last?

2. Which of the following statement is **True**

Statement 1. The legal order denied him permission to study science.

Statement 2. The legal order allowed him to study Arts.

Statement 3. The legal order allowed him to study science at his own risk.

Statement 4 The legal order allowed him to study science not at his own risk.

A. Only statement 1
B. Only statement 2
C. Only statement 3
D. Only statement 4

3. Why was Srikanth not allowed to appear for competitive examinations?

4 Name the colleges where Srikanth got admission to pursue his higher studies.

5 Identify the main clause and the subordinate clause in the given sentence:

As I did not fit into the traditional farming model, father decided education was to be my path.

Answers

1. For six months.
2. C.(iii) only statement 3
3. He could not sit for competitive exams because of his blindness.
4. MIT, Stanford, Berkeley and Carnegie Mellon.
5. Main clause: father decided education was to be my path

   Sub. Clause: As I didn't fit into the traditional farming model.

1.4. Read the following excerpt from 'A Phoenix Rises' and answer the questions that follow.

Bablu Kewat had been an indifferent student at best. He still remembers his science teacher Mrs Sharma, and the egg incubator that he had made under her supervision. But when Bablu's father died leaving his mother struggling to support her small family, he dropped out of school to get a job and help her out. business himself, growing it steadily.

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He joined a workshop as a busboy, getting tea for the owner. He slowly worked his way up to becoming a welder. Gradually he took over the mortgage of the workshop. After that, he ran the business himself, growing it steadily.

1. What was the name of the science teacher?
2. Why does he remember his science teacher?
3. Bablu joined a workshop as a
   (a) Busyboy
   (b) busboy
   (c) cowboy
   (d) bellboy
4. Why did Bablu drop out of school?
5. Identify the word that means ‘a property pledged to a bank for a loan’

Answers

1. Mrs Sharma
2. Even though he was not good at studies, he was good at experimenting with things under the supervision of teacher.
3. Busboy
4. Bablu dropped out of school because his father had died and his mother had to work hard to support the family.
5. Mortgage

1.5. Read the following excerpt from ‘A Phoenix Rises’ and answer the questions that follow.

That evening on his way back from the workshop, Bablu decided to surprise Gowri with a gift. He went to a small store. The storekeeper quickly wrapped the napkin pack in an old newspaper. Bablu was startled at the exorbitant price, but dutifully paid him forty rupees.

He unwrapped the packet and examined the pad. It seemed to be just plain cotton wrapped in a gauze sheet. He placed it on his palm, trying to calculate the approximate weight of the pad. 'Ten grams,' he said to himself.

1. How did Bablu surprise Gowri?
2. Why did the shopkeeper wrap the gift in an old newspaper?
3. Bablu was startled because of
   a. The weight of the napkin.
   b. Size of the napkin.
   c. Cover of the napkin.

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d. Cost of the napkin.

4. How did Bablu calculate the approximate weight of the napkin?
5. Identify the noun phrase and the verb phrase in the given sentence

   Bablu was startled at the exorbitant price.

Answers

1. Bablu surprised Gowri with a gift of sanitary napkin.
2. Shopkeeper wrapped the gift in a newspaper because it was a sanitary napkin.
3. d) cost of the napkin
4. Bablu calculated the approximate weight of the napkin by placing it on his palm.
5. NP- Bablu

   VP-was startled at the exorbitant price.

2. Analysing Poem

2.1 Read the following lines from 'The Seedling' and answer the questions given below.

I So it pushed a little leaflet
Up into the light of day,
To examine the surroundings
And show the rest the way.

The leaflet liked the prospect,
So it called its brother, Stem;
Then two other leaflets heard it,
And quickly followed them.

1. Who pushed 'a little leaflet'?

   a. Sun b. Boy c. Seedling d. None of the above
2. Why was the little leaflet pushed out?
3. How did the leaflet feel on coming out and what did it do ?
4. Identify the poetic craft used in the lines

   'Two other leaflets heard it,
   And quickly followed them'.

Answers

1. Seedling
2. To examine the surrounding
3. The leaflet found favourable prospects and called the brother Stem.
4. Personification

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2.2. Read the following lines from 'The Seedling' and answer the questions given below.

As a quiet little seedling
Lay within its darksome bed,
To itself it fell a-talking,
And this is what it said:
"I am not so very robust,
But I'll do the best I can;"
And the seedling from that moment
Its work of life began.

1. Which of the following statement is TRUE?
    1. Statement 1: The little seedling is very strong.
    2. Statement 2: The little seedling is not very strong but it has confidence on itself to do the best.
    3. Statement 3: The little seedling is very thin and weak.
    4. Statement 4: The little seedling is lazy to move.

    a. Only statement 1 & 4 b. Only statement 3
    c. Only statement 2 d. All of the above.

2. What does 'darksome bed' stand for

    a. Ordinary bed b. Cushion
    b. Closed box d. Earth /soil

3. What does the little seedling tell itself?
4. Identify a pair of rhyming words.

Answers

1. C
2. d)
3. "I am not so very robust
   But I'll do the best I can"
4. Seedling- talking, bed-said

Read the following lines from the poem ' The Seedling' and prepare a note of appreciation focussing on the theme, images and poetic devices.

As a quiet little seedling
Lay within its darksome bed,
To itself it fell a-talking,

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And this is what it said:

"I am not so very robust,
But I'll do the best I can;"
And the seedling from that moment
Its work of life began.
So it pushed a little leaflet
Up into the light of day,
To examine the surroundings
And show the rest the way

'The Seedling' is written by the famous American poet Paul Laurence Dunbar. The poem celebrates the ideals of perseverance, self -improvement and continuous growth. The seedling is given human qualities and its thoughts and actions are represented as human.

In the given lines the poet takes metaphor of a tiny seedling transforming into a flowering plant. The seedling lying in earth tells itself that though it is not very strong and robust, it can do its best. And with this confidence it starts to grow. The seedling pushed a small leaf from the earth to the light of the day. The leaf not only examined the surrounding but also paved the way for others to follow

The poem is rich in poetic devices. The poet uses seedling as a metaphor for life and growth. There are lot of images. There is visual imagery in 'it pushed a little leaflet up into the light of day'. There is personification in 'to itself it fell a talking'. There is alliteration in 'so it pushed a little leaflet'. There are four lines in each stanza. The rhyme scheme is ' abab.'

3. Possible Discourses

3.1. Interview Questions

You happen to be the reporter of a famous daily. You are preparing an article on the young entrepreneurs of India. You may decide to interview Srikanth Bolla, a young and promising entrepreneur. Prepare **a set of six questions** regarding his personal and professional life, challenges and his achievements and awards.

3.2 Event Invitation

You have decided to organise a workshop on start-ups and entrepreneurship. You decide to invite the famous entrepreneur Mr. Joseph Chittilapally, founder of V Guard industries. Prepare an **Event Invitation** for the programme, giving necessary details.

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Event Invitation

An event invitation formally asks specific individuals to attend an event. The tone can be formal or casual. Key information includes, the event name, date, time, location and purpose of the event.

Title	Name of the Institution Name of the event
Salutation	Dear/ Respected…….
Introduction	What- What is the event? When- date and time of the event Where- location
Information	Who- Host/ who conducts the event/ Guests of the event Why- relevance of the event How- other details of the event
Invitation	Cordially invites you…
Official details	Place…. Signature Date…. Name & Designation

Event Invitation

GVHSS Udayannur

Workshop on start-ups and Entrepreneurship

Respected Mr. Joseph Chittilapally,

Our school is organising a workshop on start-ups and entrepreneur ship on January 16th, the National Startup Day, Friday at 10 am in our school auditorium.

This event is hosted by the PTA and staff of the school to foster entrepreneurship and promote innovation. Your name is part of every family and we believe your inspiring story and the spirit to work for the society will surely encourage our students to dream big, innovate and invent.

We cordially invite you for the function. We will be honoured by your presence and we are sure this event will be an eye opener to our students.

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With warm regards,

Yours Sincerely

Place……

(Sign)

Date…….

Principal, GVHSS Udayannur

Grading Indicators

The Event Invitation

- Contained the relevant details of the programme.
- Explained the need for the programme.
- Described how the event would be conducted
- Made use of right salutation.
- Mentioned the date, time and venue of the programme
- Specified the identity and gave other relevant information Regarding the issuing authority
- Adhered to the proper format and layout.

3.3 Letter

Imagine that Srikanth Bolla gets a high salaried job in an MNC (Multi National Company). But his thoughts were different. He writes a letter to his friend sharing his feelings. Write the likely **letter.**

3.4.Diary Entry

Sreekanth Bolla passed his Matriculation Examination with over 90% marks. His father's joy knew no bounds. He writes his feelings in his diary. Write the likely **diary** entry.

3.5. Ad Jingles

The Eco -club of your school is launching bio-degradable pens that contain seeds. Prepare two rhythmic sentences that can be used to create **advertisement jingles** to promote the pens. (1*4=4)

.

- **Write with pen, watch a plant grow,**
  And make our beautiful Earth glow.
- **From sustainable trees, we craft with ease,**
  For a greener tomorrow, a gentle breeze.

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3.6. E-mail

The 3rd of November is observed as National Entrepreneurship Day. The English Club of your school plans to conduct an idea generation contest for the Young Innovators Programme (YIP). You wish to invite Arunachalam Muruganantham as the chief guest. Draft an **e-mail** to Mr Muruganantham seeking his consent and inviting him to the event.

From: (Sender's email id) gvhssudayanur@gmail.com
To: (receiver's email id) marunachalam09@gmail.com
Subject : Invitation

Dear Mr. Arunachalam Muruganantham,

I would like to introduce myself as the convenor of the English club of GVHSS Udayanur. As part of observing National Entrepreneurship day on November 3rd, the English club is conducting an Idea Generation Contest for the Young Innovators Programme (YIP) on November 4th, 2025 Friday at 3 pm in the school auditorium. We will be privileged if you honour the occasion with your presence as a famous Entrepreneur. Your contribution to the society is well known to all. Your invention has helped in empowering the rural women.

I humbly request you to accept our invitation as the chief guest for the event and kindly acknowledge.

Thanking you.

Yours Sincerely,

Place: (Signature)

Date English Club Convenor

Grading Indicators

*Proper sender's and receiver's email address

*Clear and precise language without ambiguity

*Short sentences and get straight to the point without wasting reader's time

* Courteous language

* Provide all necessary information and context for your message.

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3.7. Write-up

The strength and future of a nation depends on its youth. Nation needs the efforts of young entrepreneurs for its growth and development. Prepare a **write up** on the topic "Entrepreneurship- The need of the hour."

3.8. Biographical Sketch

Prepare a biographical sketch of Kris Gopalakrishnan, one of the founders of IT major Infosys.

Title Early life : born on 5 April 1955, Thiruvananthapuram Education: studied at Government Model Boys Higher secondary school, post- graduation in Physics and M.Tech in Computer science Career: Started career as software engineer with Patni computer System, Mumbai. Awards and honours: Padma Bhushan (2011) and honorary doctorate by University of Kerala. Major accomplishment: invested in number of start-ups, health research specifically brain science and technology driven innovations.

Kris Gopalakrishnan
Kris Gopalakrishnan, one of the founders of IT major, Infosys, was born on April 5 in 1955 at Thiruvananthapuram. He studied at Government Model Boys Higher Secondary School. He post- graduated in Physics and took M.Tech in Computer science. He started his career as a software engineer with Patni Computer System, Mumbai. He was awarded with Padma Bhushan in 2011 and an honorary doctorate by the University of Kerala. He has invested in number of startups, health research specially brain science and technology driven innovations.

3.9. Conversation

Imagine you are neighbour of Bablu Kewat and you happen to meet his wife one day. Bablu 's work is the talk of the town. You talk to his wife about it. Write the likely **conversation.**

3.10. Letter

Arunachalam Muruganantham's effort was finally successful. He writes to his wife expressing his feelings. Write the likely **letter.**

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4. Editing

Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

4.1. When I was born without eyes, society **see(a)** me as **an(b)** burden. Some even suggested that I should be smothered. But my parents **me on showered(c)** immense love and care. They felt they **was(d)** the richest **cuople(e)** in the world, and I consider **ourself(f)** the luckiest person.

Answer: (saw, a, showered on me, were, couple, myself)

4.2. After six months of legal battle, I **receive(a)** a government order allowing me to study science, but **on(b)** my own risk. **despite(c)** the lack of resources, I worked hard**, on(d)** the help of **an(e)**mentor. She recorded my textbooks on audio, and I scored 98% in my exams. This proves that anyone, regardless of their 'impairment' or challenges, **could**(f) achieve great things.

Answer:(received, at, Despite, with, a, can)

4.3. Bablu Kewat had **being(a)** an indifferent student at best. He still remembers his science teacher Mrs Sharma, and the egg incubator **who(b)** he had made under her supervision. But when **Bablus**(c) father died leaving his mother struggling to support **small her family**(d), he **drop(e)** out of school to get **an(f)** job and help her out.

Answer: (been, that, Bablu's, her small family, dropped, an)

4.4. Education **empower**(a) us. We don't **needed(**b) to beg for a job after education. Try to find solutions to social problems and create jobs for **yourself** (c)and others. Convert **all** (d) problem into an opportunity. Come out with a solution, an innovation, an enterprise. **Became**(e) solution providers and social **entrepreneurs(**f).

Answer: (empowers, need, yourselves, every, Become, entrepreneur)

5. Phrasal Verbs

Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in bracket.

5.1 My father was a weaver. I …(a)……..of school at 14 when he …(b)…….unexpectedly. My mother had to …..(c)…….the family. She could not afford to send me to college. I had to ……(d).. ….my studies and ……(e)……..a job in a wielding workshop, even as a young boy.

(give up, take up, drop out, pass away, look after)

Answer:(drop out, passed away, look after, give up, take up)

5.2. Bablu had …(a)……to make sanitary napkins that could benefit the rural women. But he could not……(b)…..the material used by the brands. He …….(c).. with his experiment until he …..(d) …….that it was pinewood pulp used. This …..(e)……to be a success in his mission.

(figure out, make out, make up his mind, go on, turn out, put out)

Answer: (made up his mind, make out, went on, figure out, turn out)

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5.3. I …(a)……Srikanth Bolla during my visit to Hyderabad. We … (b)……on a plan that could add to the sustainable growth of the country. The meeting …(c)……..for a couple of hours. Mr.Bolla ….(d).……to be a down to earth person. I was …(e)…….by his modesty and unassuming personality.

(go on, taken aback, work out, turn out, call on, put on)

Answer: (call on, work out, went on, turn out, taken aback)

5.4. Bablu was worried that Gowri might……(a)…..with infections if she ……(b)……using dirty rags. When he went to a nearby store to get a pack of napkins for her, he was ……(c)……by the exorbitant price on the packet. Bablu decided to …..(d)…..a new product to make affordable napkins keeping in mind the health and hygiene of women. Although his family and friends advised him to …..(e)….his strange experiments, he continued with it.

(taken aback, come down, put up with, give up, go on, set up)

Answer: (come down, go on, taken aback, set up, give up)

6. Cloze Type

Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the bracket.

6.1. These questions led me back to India, ….(a)…I returned, giving up all the opportunities…..(b) ….corporate America, to build….(c)…strong support system ……(d)…the disabled. We established a platform, Bollant Industries together…(e) my partner; to find, rehabilitate, nurture and reintegrate disabled individuals….(f)…society.

(in, with, where, into, a, for)

Answer: where, in, a, for, with, into

6.2. The next day all kinds …..(a)….rumours spread over the town. Unable …..(b)….bear the humiliation, Bablu's wife left him. She said she would only return …..(c)…he would give up his madness. His mother too followed suit. He had lost his wife, his family, and money that he could not afford to waste, all …..(d)….pursuit of the sanitary pad project. Bablu was a simple welder…… (e)…..life had been ripped apart. All because he had wanted to give Gowri a gift; a gift ….(f)….all the poor women in India.

(when, of, for, whose, to, in, into)

Answer: of, to, when, in, whose, for

6.3. I tried to find out …..(a)…type of cotton the popular brands were using….(b)…their napkins.It took me two years …(c)… trial and error …(d)…figure it out it was pinewood pulp and not cotton. The supplier sent me some samples. I spent several days wondering ..(e)….to make cellulose…..(f) ….it.

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(for, what, of, from, to, how)

Answer: (what, for, of, to , how, from)

7. Completing the Conversation

7.1. Complete the conversation between Srikanth and his friend.

Friend: What happened? You look worried.

Srikanth: ……(a)……..

Friend: Why don't you like your school?

Srikanth: I do not have friends. They keep me excluded from activities.

Friend: You feel you are the loneliest child in the class, …..(b)…….?

Srikanth: Yes. I wish to change this school.

Friend: In that case you had better……..(c)…….?

Srikanth: The more I think of my condition, the more….(d)…….

Friend: If you tell your father, ……(e)……

Srikanth: Yes, you are right.

Answer

a. I don't like my school.

b. don't you?

c. change to a new school.

d. the more I feel sad

e. he will help you.

7.2. Complete the conversation between Bablu and his mother.

Mother: Bablu, what are your intentions?

Bablu: I have only good intentions.

Mother: ……(a)……?

Bablu: My experiment is about helping the rural women.

Mother: ……(b)…….?

Bablu: Yes. It is about woman's menstrual cycle.

Mother: But it is shameful to talk about it, …(c)……?

Bablu: No mother. It is about the health of woman especially the rural woman.

Mother: But the society does not like it. They have started giving rude glances. You had better……(d)…….

Bablu: I cannot stop my experiment. If had worked on it earlier, ……(e)…..……..

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Answer:

a. What is your experiment about?

b. Is it about woman's menstrual cycle?

c. isn't it?

d. stop the experiment.

e. I would have found a solution/right material.

8. Reported Speech

Report the following conversations.

1. Father: My son, who is visually challenged, wants to study science in your school.
   Principal: I am sorry. We cannot allow your son to take science and study here.
2. Srikanth: Can my school be changed? My teachers and friends ignore me from all activities.
   Father: Yes, we will go to another school where there are children like you.
3. Srikanth: I have got the government order to study science but at my own risk.
   Mentor: I will help you by recording your textbooks in audio.
4. Mother: Stop your experiment. It has disgraced the family.
   Bablu: I will not. It is for the well-being of all women in the village.
5. Bablu: Please do not go to your home.
   Wife: I will return only when you give up your madness.

Answers

1. The father said that his son, who was visually challenged, wanted to study science in their school.
   The Principal replied negatively and said that they could not allow his son to take science and study there.
2. Srikanth asked his father if his school could be changed. He added that his teachers and friends ignored him from all activities.

The father replied that they would go to another school where there were children like him.

3. Srikanth said that he had got the government order to study but at his own risk.
   The Mentor replied that he would help him by recording his textbook in audio.
4. Bablu's mother asked him to stop his experiment. She added that it had disgraced the family.
   Bablu replied that he would not stop and said that it was for the well- being of all women in the village.
5. Bablu requested his wife not to go to her home.
   The wife replied that she would return only when he gave up his madness.

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9. Combine the sentence using linkers given in bracket.

(a) I see a sunset. I feel at peace. (Whenever)

(b) They finished their homework. They went to play. (After)

(c) You come out of the attic. The soldiers will notice you. (If)

(d) The bell rang. Rahul ran to the door. (As soon as)

(e) She studied hard. She passed the exam. (Because)

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UNIT 3

THE TRUMPETS OF CHANGE

1. WAR : At a glance

"War" by Luigi Pirandello is a short story set during World War I, on a train carrying several passengers. Most of them are parents of soldiers who are fighting or have fought in the war. Among them is a couple whose only son has just been sent to the front. The mother is heartbroken and says nothing, while the father tries to stay calm, even though he is also very sad.

As the train moves, the passengers start talking about their children and the war. The conversation soon becomes a debate about duty and patriotism. One man, whose son has already died in the war, speaks strongly. He says that parents should not be selfish and cry too much, because once children grow up, they belong to their country. He believes that soldiers should go to war with pride, and parents should be proud of their sacrifice instead of feeling of pain. For a while, the other passengers seem to agree with him.

The quiet father listens to all of this, but does not speak. The passengers try to comfort themselves by thinking that their sons are dying for a noble reason—to serve their country. This idea helps them feel a little better, even if only for a short time.

But then, the man who had spoken so confidently starts to show his true feelings. His voice shakes, and he becomes sad. When the grieving mother finally asks him if his son is really dead, he cannot answer right away. Then he suddenly breaks down and starts crying, realizing how much pain he truly feels.

2. A PIECE OF STRING : At a glance

The short story *"A Piece of String"* by Guy de Maupassant takes place in a small village named Goderville in France. The main character is an old peasant named Hauchecome. One day, while walking towards the public square, he notices a piece of string lying on the ground. Thinking it might be useful, he bends down and picks it up. Unfortunately, another man from the village, Malandain, sees him pick up the string. Hauchecome becomes ashamed to be seen thus by him. Malandain is not on good terms with Hauchecome. Hauchecome goes towards the market.

Later that day, it is announced that someone has lost a pocketbook in the marketplace. The finder is requested to return the same to the Mayor’s office. When people begin to discuss the possibility of finding it, a chief of the police appears and informs Hauchecome that he is to meet the Mayor. The Mayor tells Hauchecome that he was seen picking up the lost pocketbook. Hauchecome is shocked

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and tries to explain that he only picked up a piece of string. He even shows the string to prove his honesty. But no one believes him. Even after the wallet is found by someone else and returned to its owner, the villagers still think Hauchecome was involved somehow.

Despite being innocent, Hauchecome finds that people continue to treat him as if he is guilty. They mock him, whisper behind his back, and avoid him. This unfair treatment deeply affects him. He becomes obsessed with proving his innocence and keeps repeating his story to everyone he meets, hoping someone will believe him. But instead of gaining sympathy, people think he is lying even more. Over time, the stress and shame become too much for him to bear. His health worsens, and eventually, he dies, heartbroken and defeated. The story clearly shows how easily people judge others without proof and how once a person's reputation is damaged, it is very difficult to repair, even if they are truly innocent.

3. Another Day in Paradise : At a glance

The song tells the story of a homeless woman struggling on the streets. She suffers from cold and hunger and has blisters on her feet. Passers-by, including the singer, ignore her plight, showing society's general indifference. Through the refrain "Oh, think twice, it's another day for you and me in paradise," the singer reminds us to be compassionate and help those in need. The song highlights poverty, homelessness, and moral responsibility.

1. READING COMPREHENSION

1.1. ***Read the following excerpt from 'War' and answer the questions that follow.***

The passengers who had left Rome by the night express had to stop until dawn at the small station of Fabriano. They then needed to continue their journey by the old- fashioned local train to Sulmona.

At dawn, in a stuffy and smoky second class carriage in which a few people had already spent the night, a stout woman in deep mourning was hoisted in. Behind her, puffing and moaning, followed her husband—a tiny man, thin and weak, his face death-white. His eyes were small and bright and he looked shy and uneasy. Having at last taken a seat, he politely thanked the passengers who had helped his wife by making room for her.

1. Where did the passengers by the night express have to stop until dawn?
2. How would the passengers continue their journey to Sulmona?
3. How is the second class carriage described?
4. What is special about the second class carriage?
    a. A few people had already spent the night in it.

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b. It was stuffy and smoky.

c. It was part of the train going to Fabriano.

i) a & b are correct ii) b &c are correct

iii) a & c are correct iv) a, b & c are correct

5. Why did the husband thank the passengers?

Answers

1. at the small station of Fabriano
2. by the old- fashioned local train
3. stuffy and smoky
4. i) a & b are correct
5. for having helped his wife by making room for her

1.2. ***Read the following excerpt from 'War' and answer the questions that follow.***

And he felt it his duty to explain to his travelling companions that the poor woman was to be pitied. The war was taking away from her their only son, a boy of twenty. Both of them had devoted their entire life to him. They had even broken up their home at Sulmona to follow him to Rome, where he had to go as a student. They allowed him to volunteer for war with an assurance that for at least six months he would not be sent to the war front. And now, all of a sudden, they received a wire from him saying that he was due to leave in three days' time. They were now going to see him off.

The woman was twisting and wriggling, at times growling like a wild animal. She felt certain that all those explanations would not have aroused even a shadow of sympathy from those people. They were all, most likely, in the same plight as herself.

1. What did the husband feel his duty?
2. Why did the couple break up their home at Sulmona?
3. What was the assurance by which the couple allowed their son to volunteer for war?
4. The couple was going to Sulmona because

a. their son joined the war front.

b. they had devoted their entire life to their son.

c. they had broken up their home at Sulmona.

d. they wanted to see their son off for having received a wire.

5. Why did the woman feel certain that her husband's humble explanations would not have aroused even a shadow of sympathy from the other passengers?

Answers

1. to explain to his travelling companions that the poor woman was to be pitied

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2. to follow their son to Rome, where he had to go as a student

3. for at least six months he would not be sent to the war front

4. d. they wanted to see their son off for having received a wire

5. They were all, most likely, in the same plight as herself.

1.3. ***Read the following excerpt from 'War' and answer the questions that follow.***

"Bosh!" retorted the stout traveller. "Do we think of the country when we give life to our children? We belong to them but they never belong to us. And when they reach twenty, they are exactly what we were at their age. Now, at our age, the love of our Country is still great, of course, but stronger than it is the love of our children. Is there any one of us here who wouldn't gladly take his son's place at the front if he could?"

There was a silence all round, everybody nodding as if to approve. The stout man continued, "Isn't it natural that at their age they should consider the love for their Country even greater than their love for us? If Country is a natural necessity like bread, somebody must go to defend it. And our sons go, when they are twenty, and they don't want tears, because if they die, they die happy.

Everyone should stop crying; everyone should laugh, as I do… or at least thank God—as I do—because my son, before dying, sent me a message. He was dying satisfied at having ended his life in the best way he could have wished. That is why, as you see, I do not even wear mourning…"

1. 'Now, at our age, the love of our Country is still great, of course, but stronger than it is the love of our children.' What does this statement indicate?

    a. They love their country more than their children.

    b. They love their children more than their country.

    c. They do not want to send their children to volunteer for war.

    d. Their children do not wish to volunteer for war.

2. Why must somebody go to defend the country?

3. Why does the stout man thank God?

4. What did the stout man's son communicate to his father before dying?

5. The stout man doesn't wear morning because

    a. he doesn't feel sad.

    b. his son had ended his life in the best way he could have wished.

    c. his son didn't go to volunteer for war.

    d. everyone else in the compartment doesn't wear mourning.

Answers

1. b. They love their children more than their country.

2. Because the country is a natural necessity like bread.

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3. Because before dying, his son had sent him a message saying that he was dying satisfied.

4. He was dying satisfied at having ended his life in the best way he could have wished.

5. b. his son had ended his life in the best way he could have wished.

1.4. ***Read the following excerpt from 'A Piece of String' and answer the questions that follow.***

Along all the roads around Goderville, the peasants and their wives were coming to the town because it was market day. Some led a cow or a calf by a cord, and their wives, walking behind the animal, whipped it with a leafy branch to hasten its progress. In the public square of Goderville, there was a crowd, a throng of human beings and animals.

Hauchecome had just arrived at Goderville, and he was walking towards the public square. Then he saw a little piece of string on the ground. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up. He took the bit of thin cord from the ground and began to roll it carefully. Then he noticed Malandain, on the threshold of his door, looking at him. They were on bad terms with each other. Hauchecome was seized with shame to be seen thus by his enemy. He concealed his find quickly in his trousers pocket. He pretended to be looking on the ground for something else. Then, he went towards the market.

1. What were the wives of peasants doing to hasten the progress of the cow or the calf?
2. Which was the destination of the peasants and their wives?
3. Why did Hauchecome take the bit of thin cord from the ground?
4. Hauchecome was seized with shame because …….
    a. He was on bad terms with Malandain.
    b. He picked up the piece of string from the ground.
    c. He was seen by his enemy picking up the piece of string.
    d. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up.
5. What did Hauchecome do after picking up the piece of string?
    a. He began to roll it carefully.
    b. He concealed his find quickly in his trousers pocket.
    c. He pretended to be looking on the ground for something else.
    d. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up.

i) a, b and c ii) b, c and d iii) a, b and d iv) a, c and d

Answers

1. (a) They were whipping the cow or the calf with a leafy branch to hasten its progress
2. The peasants and their wives were coming to the town.

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3. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up.

4. c. He was seen by his enemy picking up the piece of string.

5. i) a, b and c

1.5. ***Read the following excerpt from 'A Piece of String' and answer the questions that follow.***

"This is hereby made known to the inhabitants of Goderville, and to all persons present at the market: There was lost this morning on the road, between nine and ten o'clock, a black leather pocketbook containing five hundred francs and some business papers. The finder is requested to return the same with all haste to the Mayor's office. There will be twenty francs reward."

Then the man went away and the peasants began to talk of this event. They discussed the chances of finding or not finding the pocketbook. They were finishing their coffee when a chief of the gendarmes appeared.

1. What was the content of the lost pocketbook?
2. Who is the announcement addressed?
3. What reward was offered to the person who returns the pocketbook?
4. When did a chief of the gendarmes appear?
5. What is NOT true about the lost pocketbook?
    a. It was lost that morning on the road, between nine and ten o'clock
    b. The villagers discussed the chances of finding or not finding it.
    c. The finder was requested to return to the owner immediately.
    d. It contained five hundred francs and some business papers.

Answers

1. five hundred francs and some business papers
2. the inhabitants of Goderville, and to all persons present at the market
3. twenty francs
4. When the peasants were finishing their coffee
5. c. The finder was requested to return to the owner immediately.

1.6. ***Read the following excerpt from 'A Piece of String' and answer the questions that follow.***

The next day about one o'clock in the afternoon, an employee in a shop returned the pocketbook. The man claimed to have found the object in the road. Not knowing how to read, he had given it to his employer. The news spread through the neighbourhood.

Hauchecome was informed of it. He immediately began to recount his story with its happy climax. He was in triumph. He talked of his adventure all day long. He told it on the highway to people who

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were passing by, in the wine shop to people who were drinking there and to persons coming out of church the following Sunday. He stopped strangers to tell them about it.

He was calm now, and yet something disturbed him. People had the air of joking while they listened. They did not seem convinced. He seemed to feel that remarks were being made behind his back.

1. Why did the employee give the pocketbook to his employer?
2. Hauchecome was in triumph because ……
    a. he thought that his innocence could be proved.
    b. the news spread through the neighbourhood.
    c. the man claimed to have found the object in the road.
    d. the man had given the pocketbook to his employer.
3. He stopped strangers to tell them about it. What does this statement indicate?
    a. Hauchecome was informed about the news of finding the pocketbook.
    b. The news spread through the neighbourhood.
    c. Hauchecome was too excited to share the news about his innocence.
    d. Everybody was very much interested to listen to Hauchecome.
4. How did the villagers respond to Hauchecome's sharing of the news?
5. He immediately began to recount his story with its happy climax. What does the expression 'happy climax' suggest?

Answers

1. He didn't know how to read it.
2. a. he thought that his innocence could be proved.
3. c. Hauchecome was too excited to share the news about his innocence.
4. People had the air of joking while they listened. They did not seem convinced.
5. The pocketbook was found out by an employee.

2. Analysing Song

Read the given lines from the song 'Another Day in Paradise' and answer the questions that follow.

She calls out to the man on the street

"Sir, can you help me?

It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep

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Is there somewhere you can tell me?"

He walks on, doesn't look back

He pretends he can't hear her

Starts to whistle as he crosses the street

Seems embarrassed to be there

Oh think twice, 'cause it's another day for

You and me in paradise

Oh think twice, 'cause it's another day for you

You and me in paradise

Just think about it

1. Who do you think is the “she” referred to in the opening line of the song?

Ans: The “she” refers to a homeless woman. She is not a particular individual but a representative of the poor, needy, homeless, and marginalized in society.

2. Who could be the man the woman addresses as “sir”?

Ans: The man addressed as “sir” is an ordinary passer-by. He represents the privileged members of society who often ignore the sufferings of the homeless instead of helping them.

3. What help is the woman asking for?

Ans: The woman is asking for shelter, comfort, and human kindness. She pleads for basic help and compassion because she has no place to stay and is suffering on the streets.

4. What is the problem the woman is facing as suggested in the line “It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep”?

Ans: The woman is facing homelessness and lack of shelter. She has no protection from the cold and no safe place to sleep at night.

5. Where is the woman found sitting?

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Ans: The woman is found sitting on the street, on the pavement/sidewalk, pleading for help from passers-by.

6. What do you understand about the attitude of the man from the line “He walks on, doesn’t look back”?

Ans: This shows the man’s indifferent and insensitive attitude. Instead of helping, he ignores the woman and walks away without compassion.

7. Which action by the man does not show his emotional detachment?

1. Walking on without looking back
2. Pretending he can't hear the woman
3. Whistling and crossing the street
4. Thinking twice about paradise

Ans: 4

8. What could the man be embarrassed at?

Ans: He is embarrassed at his lack of compassion and unwillingness to help. Deep down, he knows it is his moral duty to respond, but he chooses to ignore her suffering.

9. Why does the man whistle as he crosses the street?

Ans: The man whistles to appear carefree. It is his way of hiding guilt and avoiding the uncomfortable feeling of having ignored the homeless woman.

10. Comment on the refrain of the song.

Ans: The refrain “Oh, think twice, it’s another day for you and me in paradise” reminds us to be aware of the suffering around us. It contrasts the comfort of our lives (“paradise”) with the hardships of the homeless, urging empathy and compassion.

Stanza II

She calls out to the man on the street

He can see she's been crying

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She's got blisters on the soles of her feet

She can't walk but she's trying

Oh think twice, 'cause it's another day for

You and me in paradise

Oh think twice, it's just another day for you

You and me in paradise

Just think about it

Questions

1. Pick out a word from the stanza which is a symbol of the woman's long suffering.

Ans: The word "blisters" symbolizes her long suffering. It highlights her physical pain and the harsh reality of her life.

2. What do you understand about the woman's condition from the line "She's got blisters on the soles of her feet"?

Ans: It shows she suffers from walking long distances without proper footwear, reflecting her poverty, hardship, and the painful reality of homelessness.

3. Why is the woman unable to walk?

Ans: She is unable to walk because of painful blisters caused by walking long distances without proper shoes.

4. What do you understand about the woman's nature from the clause "can't walk but she's trying"?

Ans: This shows her determination and resilience. Despite pain and suffering, she struggles on, reflecting courage and perseverance.

5. Why does the singer repeat the lines "Oh, think twice, 'cause it's another day for you and me in paradise"?

Ans: The repetition emphasizes the contrast between our comfort and the suffering of the homeless. It reminds listeners to show compassion.

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STANZA III

Oh Lord, is there nothing more anybody can do?

Oh Lord, there must be something you can say.

You can tell from the lines on her face,

You can see that she's been there,

Probably moved on from every place,

’Cause she didn't fit in there.

Oh, think twice, ’cause it's another day for

You and me in paradise.

Oh, think twice, it's just another day for you

You and me in paradise.

Just think about it.

Just think about it.

It's just another day for you and me in paradise.

It's just another day for you and me in paradise.

It's just another day for you and me in paradise.

Just think about it.

Questions:

1. What does the singer pray on seeing the suffering of the woman?

Ans: On seeing the woman’s suffering, the singer prays to the Lord for compassion and mercy. He wishes that people, including himself, would notice the hardships of the poor and help those in need instead of ignoring them.

2. What do the ‘lines on her face’ symbolize?

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Ans: The “lines on her face” symbolize the hardship, suffering, and struggles the woman has endured over the years. They reflect a life of poverty, pain, and relentless challenges.

3. Pick out a symbol of suffering from the third stanza.

Ans: A symbol of suffering from the third stanza is the “lines on her face.” This symbol represents the long years of hardship, struggle, and pain the woman has endured in her life.

4. The woman has been moved on from every place. Who might have made her move on?

Ans: The woman has likely been moved on by shopkeepers, passers-by, or authorities who did not want her begging or staying on the streets. This shows society’s indifference and lack of compassion toward the homeless.

5. Why has the woman been moved on from every place?

Ans: The woman has been moved on from every place because society does not want homeless people lingering in public areas. People and authorities ignore her suffering and force her to leave, reflecting indifference and lack of empathy.

Appreciation of the song ‘Another Day in Paradise’

Phil Collins’ song ‘Another Day in Paradise’ tells the story of a homeless woman who pleads for help on the street but is ignored by a passer-by. The song contrasts her suffering with the comfort of others, reminding listeners to reflect on their own humanity.

The theme of the song centers on compassion, responsibility, and the difference between the privileged and the marginalized. The song is composed of three stanzas with a recurring chorus. It also uses rhyming pairs like street–feet, denies–cries, twice–paradise, etc., to create a smooth lyrical flow. Visual images (e.g., “blisters on the soles of her feet”) and auditory images (e.g., “she calls out to the man on the street”) make the scene vivid. Devices such as anaphora (e.g., “you can… you can,” “Oh Lord… Oh Lord”), repetition (“think twice”), and irony in the use of the word ‘paradise’ intensify the message of the song.

The song blends simple structure with powerful imagery and poetic devices to deliver a moving moral appeal against apathy.

Grading Indicators to be considered while preparing poetic appreciation

Title – Mention the name of the work.

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Poet/Songwriter – Mention the name of the poet/songwriter.

Theme – The central idea of the poem/song.

Summary – A brief outline of what the poem/song is about.

Form/Structure – Number of stanzas, type of poem/song (lyric, ballad, narrative), etc.

Rhyme Scheme and Rhyming Pairs – Identify the rhyme pattern and rhyming pairs, if any.

Imagery – Use of visual, auditory, tactile, olfactory, and gustatory images that appeal to the senses.

Poetic Devices/Figures of Speech – e.g., metaphor, simile, personification, irony, symbolism, anaphora, alliteration, repetition, etc.

Tone/Mood – The emotional quality (serious, reflective, joyful, sad, satirical, etc.).

Language – Simplicity, colloquial words, figurative language, etc.

Message/Social Relevance – The message conveyed.

Personal Response – Your impression of how the poem/song affects or inspires you.

Poetic Devices with Examples

1. Visual Image

a) A woman on the street

b) A man crossing the street

c) “blisters on the soles of her feet”

d) “Lines on her face”

2. Auditory Image

a) The woman calling out to the man

b) The man whistling

c) The woman crying

3. Tactile Image

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e.g., “It's cold here”

4. Refrain / Repetition

e.g., “Oh, think twice, it’s another day for you and me in paradise”

5. Symbolism

a) “Blisters” – Represents suffering and hardship

b) “Lines on her face” – Symbolizes years of struggle

c) “Paradise” – Represents comfort, privilege, and safety

6. Apostrophe (Direct Address)

e.g., “Oh, think twice” – Appeals directly to the listener

7. Anaphora

e.g., “She's got… She can't…”

3. Possible Discourses

3.1. Narrative

The grieving husband in the story ‘War’ narrated the conversation and experiences in the train to one of his friends after reaching home. Prepare the possible **narrative.**

AN UNFORGETTABLE DAY

My friend, yesterday was an unforgettable day for me. When we received a message from our son three days before, we were literally shocked. To see him off, we were going to Sulmona by the local train. The passengers in the train made room for my wife who was extremely sad. Everyone in the compartment noticed us. Then I thought I would explain the situation of us and the reason for my wife’s sadness. When I said that our only son was leaving to volunteer for war, a passenger said that we should thank God because his son had been sent to war the first day itself. Another passenger said that he had two sons and three nephews at the front.

There was a debate about parental love. One said that it was not like bread which can be broken into pieces and split amongst the children in equal shares. Then a stout red faced man with blood shot eyes questioned if we gave life to our children for our own benefit. We stared at him in distress. The one who had his son at the front since the first day of the war sighed and asked if

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there was any one of us who wouldn't gladly take his son's place at the front if he could.

He opined that if country was a natural necessity like bread, somebody must go to defend it. He added that when our sons die, they die happy and so, they didn't want our tears. He also shared an experience of receiving a message from his son before dying. He said that he was dying satisfied at having ended his life in the best way he could have wished. That was why he was not mourning. Immediately my wife turned to him and asked if his son was really dead. We stared at her. And we could see the old man struggling for words to reply. We saw his face contracted and became horribly distorted. Then to our amazement, he broke into tears, and cried bitterly. We were deeply touched his his unexpected bursting out and all of us were sad too.

Value points

Suitable Title
Sequencing the events properly
Suitable choice of words and sentence varieties
Figurative Language
Proper beginning and ending

3.2. Conversation

a. Imagine you are one of the passengers on the train in the story 'War'. You are getting a chance to talk to the grieving father after his emotional breakdown. Prepare the possible **conversation.**

Myself : Hey, Why are you so sad?
Father : You know, he's my only son.
Myself : But why don't you think about the others suffering?
Father : Yes, that's true. But at least they have more than one child.
Myself : Let me share my case. I had two sons and both lost their lives in an accident.
Father : I feel sorry about that. How do you survive?
Myself : I thank God for giving them to me. I feel their presence always in my life.
Father : That could be a great experience.
Myself : Be optimistic. Your son is going to protect our country.
Father : Let us hope so.

b. One of the passengers really felt empathy for the woman. Imagine he talks to her. Prepare a possible **conversation** between the grieving mother and the co-passenger in the train.

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c. After meeting the Mayor, Hauchecome returns to his home. Imagine that he meets one of his friends on the way. Prepare a possible **conversation** between the two.

3.3. Diary Entry

a. Imagine the man who claimed to be proud of his son's death in the story 'War' is writing his diary the night after the train journey. What might he write in his **diary** about why he broke down and what he truly feels about his son's sacrifice?

4 November 1916

Wednesday

An unforgettable day in my life! The train journey to Sulmona of today will forever in my memory. Surrounded by strangers – fathers and mothers like me carrying bleeding hearts and tearful faces. I told them proudly that my son was happy for having ended his life the best way he could have wished. My words sounded firm, and I could see them listening to me carefully. I saw even certain eyes looking at with with admiration, astonishment and so on. But at last…. A lady asked me a question. "Is your son really dead?" It was terrible. I couldn't help bursting out into tears. Yes… I cried bitterly. Once again I realized that my son is no longer alive.

b. One of the passengers in the train in 'War' was deeply moved after listening to various perspectives of the themes discussed by the other travellers. Imagine he writes his diary sharing his views on the same. Draft the possible **diary entry**.

c. Hauchecome was excited and joyful when he came to know that the pocketbook was found. He was sure that his innocence could be proved. After reaching home, he started scribbling his emotions and feelings in his diary. Draft the possible **diary entry.**

d. Imagine that Malandain feels regret about his action after the death of Hauchecome. He notes down his emotions in his diary. Draft the possible **diary entry.**

3.4. Letter

The grieving mother in the story 'War' became immensely relieved after listening to the experiences shared by the man whose son had died in the war. After the train journey, she writes a letter to one of her friends. Draft the likely **letter.**

3.5. Interview Questions

A journalist interviews one of the other passengers inn the compartment in the story 'War' a few days later. Prepare a set of **five questions** to be used for the interview.

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3.6. Character Sketch

The grieving father in the story 'War' is a symbol of any parent who feels extremely agonized while losing his or her child even if for a noble purpose. Prepare a **character sketch** of the grieving father, highlighting his inner struggle, emotions, and response to the discussion on the train.

3.7. Paragraph

Prepare a **paragraph** on how war affects people, especially women and children, citing instances appropriate to the context from the short story 'War' by Luigi Pirandello.

3.8. Write-up

Pirandello tries to bring out deep emotional conflicts about the sacrifice through simple conversations and it gives touching insights about the reality of war. Prepare a **write – up** on the basis of the short story.

3.9. News Report

The death of Hauchecome was reported by one of the local newspapers at Goderville. Prepare the possible **news report.**

3.10. Letter

After being accused of taking the pocketbook, Hauchcome becomes immensely desperate. He decides to write a letter to one of his friends. Draft the possible **letter.**

3.11. Profile

Prepare a brief profile of Guy de Maupassant using the hints given below.

Born	: 5 August 1850, France
Pen name	: Guy de Valmont, Joseph Prunier
Occupation	: Novelist, short story writer, poet, comedian
Genre	: Naturalism, Realism
Major works	: Boule de Suif, Deux Amis, Mother Savage etc.
Died	: 6 July 1893 (aged 43), Paris, France
Resting Place	: Montparnasse Cemetery, Paris

4. PHRASAL VERBS

Fill in the blanks using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

4.1. The stout woman and her husband ……...(a)……. to go to Sulmona and they ……..(b)…… by the old – fashioned local train. She had …….(c)……. her mourning and hoisted in the second class carriage. Her husband …….(d)…… his gratitude to the other passengers for making room for her. She couldn't ……(e)……. her grief as they were going to see their son off.

(put across, make up their mind, make out, put up with, set out, put on)

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4.2. It was heartbreaking that the war started to ……..(a)……. from the couple their only son. They were ready to …...(b)…… their home at Sulmona to follow him to Rome. They were under the impression that he wouldn't be …….(c)……. to volunteer for war for at least six months. But now they were able to …….(d)…… that he was due to leave in three days time. They were going to ….. (e)….. him before he leaves.

(break up, go through, take away, call on, call for, make out)

4.3. Hauchecome was ……(a)……. when the Mayor …….(b)…… the news about the pocketbook. Though terrified, he was not ready to …….(c)…….. and …….(d)…… explaining that he had picked up just a piece of string. Soon he …….(e)…… that Malandain was the one behind all such false accusations.

(go on, taken aback, make out, give in, put across)

4.4. The next day, Hauchecome decided to ……(a)…...the tavern. He hoped that since the pocketbook was …….(b)……, he could easily …….(c)……. the accusations on him. A horse dealer …….(d)……. to him. He told Hauchecome that at any rate he was ……..(e)…….. it.

(mix up with, put back, call at, get over, call out)

Answers

1. (a) made up their mind	(b) set out	(c) put on
(d) put across	(e) put up with	
2. (a) take away	(b) break up	(c) called for
(d) make out	(e) call on	
3. (a) taken aback	(b) put across	(c) give in
(d) went on	(e) made out	
4. (a) call at	(b) put back	(c) get over
(d) called out	(e) mixed up with	

5. COMPLETING THE CONVERSATION

5.1. Complete the following conversation between two passengers in the train.

Passenger 1: If the war had not broken out, our sons …….(a)……...

Passenger 2: Yes, I too believe so. But they are not. That is the reality. We had better ……..(b)……...

Passenger 1: ……..(c)……. ?

Passenger 2: Because others do not feel the pain we feel; they speak of glory from a distance.

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Passenger 1: Fathers here find no comfort in such sacrifice, ……...(d)……?

Passenger 2: You are correct. Fathers find not comfort, but only a little strength to endure.

Passenger 1: Would you mind ……...(e)…….?

Passenger 2: I remind myself each day that he fights for his country; that is the only way how I can keep myself calm.

Answers

(a) would still have been safe at home

(b) accept this truth

(c) Why must parents like us silently suffer?

(d) do they?

(e) telling me how you manage to stay calm?

5.2. Complete the following conversation between two villagers at Goderville.

Villager 1: ……..(a)……..?

Villager 2: No, I didn't get the latest news.

Villager 1: Hauchecome passed away yesterday.

Villager 2: He was accused of picking up the pocketbook, …….(b)……..?

Villager 1: Yes. But an employee in a shop had returned it.

Villager 2: I heard so. Still nobody was ready to believe it. If people had believed it, ……..(c)……..

Villager 1: Hauchcome was weak in defending himself. He had better ……...(d)…….

Villager 2: Yeah. He should have shared his sadness with someone.

Villager 1: Would you mind …….(e)……..?

Villager 2: No, I'm ready to accompany you to Mayor's office.

Answers

a. Did you get the latest news?

b. Wasn't he?

c. he would have survived.

d. share his emotions with his friends.

e. accompanying me to Mayor's office?

5.3. Complete the following conversation between an officer and the Mayor suitably.

Officer: Mr. Mayor, villagers do not believe Maitre Hauchecorne's story of just picking up a string, ……...(a)……?

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Mayor : No, they don't. They all insist he must have stolen the pocketbook.

Officer: If Hauchecorne was truly innocent, ……...(b)……...

Mayor : Yes, he was not very calm.

Officer: ……...(c)……?

Mayor: Because he thinks that by repeating it, people will finally believe him.

Officer: ……...(d)…….?

Mayor: Yes, we should continue to investigate. The villagers are still suspicious. Would you mind ……...(e)…….?

Mayor: No, I will keep the case open for a little longer.

Answers

(a) do they?

(b) He would have stayed calm

(c) Why does he keep repeating the same tale again and again to everyone he meets?

(d) Do you think we should continue to investigate?

(e) keeping the case open a little longer?

To Remember:

10. Conditional sentences

5. Type 1 : If clause—-> sub + V1 (simple present)
   main clause—-> sub + will/shall/may/can + V(root) (simple future)

- Type 2 :If clause—-> sub + V2 (simple past)
  main clause—-> sub + would/could/might + V(root) (simple past)

6. Type 3 : If clause—-> sub+ had+ V3 (past perfect)
   main clause—-> sub+ would/could/might + have + V3 (past perfect)

11. Had better + V (root)
12. Would mind + V + -ing form
13. Wh question—--> Wh- word + Auxiliary verb + sub + V (root)
14. Yes/No question—-> Auxiliary verb + sub + V (root)
15. Question Tag- Auxiliary verb + pronoun

Auxiliary verbs and Contracted forms of Negative Auxiliary Verbs

7. is ⇔ isn't
8. are ⇔ aren't
9. **am ⇔ aren't**

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10. was ⇔ wasn't
11. were ⇔ weren't
12. has ⇔ hasn't
13. have ⇔ haven't
14. had ⇔ hadn't
15. **will ⇔ won't**
16. can ⇔ can't
17. would ⇔ wouldn't
18. could ⇔ couldn't
19. does ⇔ doesn’t
20. do ⇔ don't
21. did ⇔ didn't

Splitting main verb into Auxiliary Verb + V (root)

completes (present singular) - does + complete
complete (present plural) - do + complete
completed (past) - did + complete
goes (present singular) - does + go
go (present plural) - do + go
went (past) - did + go

E. Let's go there (suggestion) - shall we?
F. Let me…..… - shall I?
G. Let us go early. (asking permission) – won’t you?
H. Come here (positive imperative)- won't you?
I. Don’t go there (negative imperative)- will you?

6. REPORTED SPEECH

Change the following conversations into reported speech.

1. Officer: “Is Mr Hauchecome here?”
   Hauchecome: “Here I am”
2. The Mayor: “ Mr. Hauchecome, you were seen this morning picking up the lost pocketbook.”
   Hauchecome: "Who said that he saw me?”
3. Passenger : “When did you get the information from your son?”
   Old man : “We received the wire yesterday.”

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4. Stout traveller : “Do we think of our country when we give life to our children?”
   Passenger : “You are right. They don’t belong to us.”
5. Passenger : “I have two sons and three nephews at the war front?”
   Husband : “What difference can it make?”

Answers

1. The officer asked Hauchecome if he was there.
   Hauchecome replied that he was there.
2. The Mayor told Hauchecome that he had been seen that morning picking up the lost pocketbook.
   Hauchecome asked the Mayor who had said that he had seen Hauchcome.
3. The passenger asked the old man when he had got the information from his son.
   The old man replied that they had received the wire the day before.
4. The stout traveller asked the passenger if they thought of their country when they gave life to their children.
   The passenger replied that he was right and added that they didn’t belong to them.
5. The passenger told the husband that he had two sons and three nephews at the war front.
   The husband asked what difference it could make.

Reported Speech Rules Table

Type of Sentence	Reporting Word	Connecting Word	Change in Subject + Verb Word Order	Change in Tense Form of Verb	Other Common Changes
Statement (Declarative)	said, told, explained, remarked, added	that	No change (S + V order remains the same)	Simple Present → Simple Past Present Continuous → Past Continuous Present Perfect →	Pronouns change according to context (I → he/she) Time words: now → then, today → that day,

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				Past Perfect Past Simple → Past Perfect	tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the previous day Place words: here → there, this → that, these → those
Yes/No Question	asked, inquired, wanted to know	if / whether	Verb comes after Subject (normal statement order)	Same tense changes as above	Question mark is dropped Pronouns and time/place words change as in statements
Wh-Question	asked, wondered, inquired	wh-word (who, what, where, why, when, how)	Verb comes after Subject (statement order)	Same tense changes as above	Question mark is dropped Pronouns and time/place words change as in statements
Imperative (Command /	told, ordered,	to / not to +	No change in word	Verb changes to	Please/ kindly →

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Request / Advice)	requested, advised, urged, begged	verb	order	infinitive (to + base verb)	requested Negative commands: 'Don't…' → told/asked not to…
Exclamatory Sentence	exclaimed, cried out, said with joy/sorrow/ wonder	that	No change in word order	Same tense changes as in statements	Interjections change: oh! → exclaimed in surprise alas! → exclaimed with sorrow hurrah! → exclaimed with joy wow! → exclaimed in wonder

7. Cloze Type

Fill in the blanks using the appropriate word from the bracket.

7.1 And he felt it his duty ….(a)….. explain to his travelling companions ….(b)….. the poor woman was to be pitied. The war was taking away …...(c)….. her their only son, a boy ….(d)…… twenty.

(from, to, of, with, that)

Answers : a. to b. that c. from d. of

7.2 She felt certain …..(a)….. all those explanations would not have aroused even …..(b)….. shadow of sympathy …..(c)….. those people. They were all, most likely, …..(d)…. the same plight ….. (e)….. herself.

(a, in, with, that, as, from)

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Answers: a. that b. a c. from d. in e. as

7.3 Hauchecome had just arrived …..(a)…. Goderville, and he was walking …...(b)….. the public square. Then he saw …...(c)….. little piece …..(d)….. string …...(e)….. the ground.

(of, a, on, at, with, toward)

Answers: a. at b. toward c. a d. of e. on

7.4 The countryman was astounded. He looked …..(a)….. the Mayor. He was terrified …..(b)….. this suspicion resting ….(c)….. him. He said …..(d)….. he hadn't taken it.

(by, at, with, that, on)

Answers: a. at b. by c. on d. that

8. EDITING

Edit the following passage. The errors are underlined.

8.1. *A Piece of String* is a <u>brilliant</u> (a) crafted short story that <u>explore</u> (b) the <u>destruction</u> (c) power of suspicion and the <u>fragelity</u> (d) of reputation <u>with</u> (e) a small-town setting.

Answers: a. brilliantly b. explores c. destructive

d. fragility e. in

8.2. Rather than <u>glorify</u> (a) heroism, Maupassant focuses on the fear, suffering, and moral <u>ambigiuty</u> (b) that war <u>bring</u> (c) to ordinary people. His characters <u>struggles</u> (d) with the harsh realities of conflict, revealing how war can <u>stripped</u> (e) individuals of their dignity, security, and humanity.

Answers : a. glorifying b. ambiguity c. brings

d. struggle e. strip

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